BRAND REVIEW · Q2 FY2026

RootDay — Q2 FY2026 Brand Review & FY27 Outlook

A $62M oat-milk franchise riding the category's fastest adjacency

Document type Internal brand review
Period Q2 FY2026 · FY27 outlook
Owner Brand Manager — RootDay (Lillian Park, Innovation lead, contributor)
Prepared July 2026

FY25 net revenue	**$62M (acquired 2023; ~12.3M units)**
Q2 FY26 vs plan (Apr–May)	**$10.9M actual vs $10.9M plan · -0.2%**
Category tailwind	**Oat plant-based milk +18.8% (fastest adjacency)**
Barista trend strength	**0.84 — the volume engine of oat milk**
FY27 headline call	**Grow with the category; land Coffee Creamer, hold Single-Serve**

Executive summary

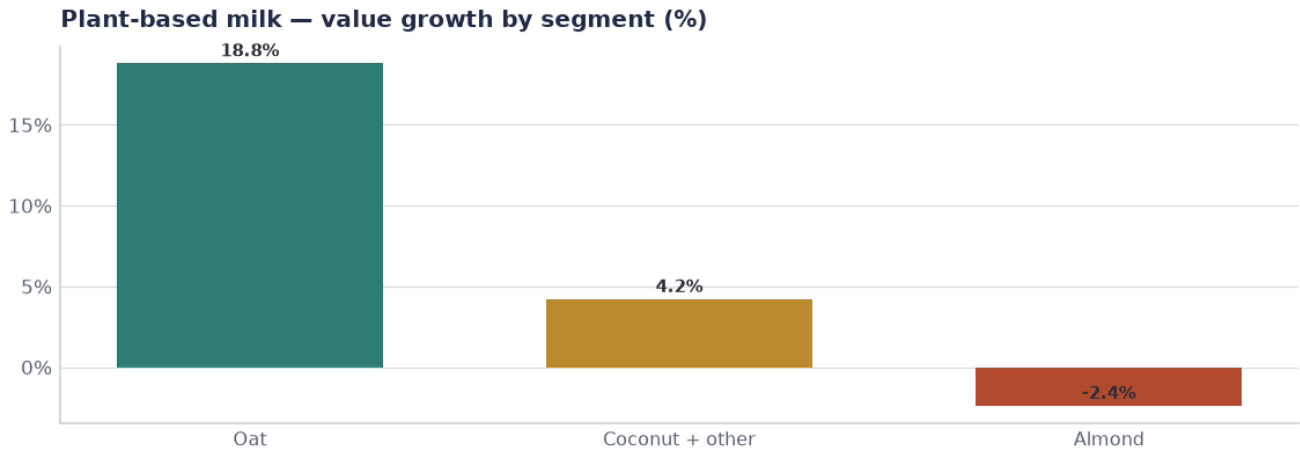
RootDay is a small brand in a fast lane. Oat-milk — the plant-based-milk pocket where RootDay lives — grew +18.8% in FY25 to $1.64B while almond declined and coconut stalled, and the barista/foodservice use-case (trend strength 0.84) is the volume engine underneath that growth. The brand is on plan: Q2 FY26 is running -0.2% to plan (essentially flat), the steadiest read in the Acme portfolio. The FY27 job is simple to state and disciplined to execute — grow with the category, not against it: extend into the barista/creamer occasion, prune the tail, and avoid over-investing ahead of demand.

- **On plan.** RootDay ran –0.3% to plan in Jan–Mar and -0.2% in Apr–May FY26 — the tightest plan adherence of any Acme brand (plan_vs_actual).
- **The tailwind is real and specific.** Oat is the only growing plant-based-milk segment (+18.8% FY25); almond is in structural decline (–2.4%) and the barista occasion (0.84) is where the incremental volume sits.
- **FY27 innovation is a two-item agenda:** advance *RootDay Coffee Creamer 16oz* (Stage-2 concept, $3.8M yr-1 planning estimate, target 2027-Q3) into the barista/creamer occasion; hold *Single-Serve Carton 8oz* (Stage-3, On-Hold).
- **Prune the tail.** Coconut Blend is slated to discontinue in Q3 FY26 — a low-velocity SKU in a low-growth segment (coconut+other +4.2% vs oat +18.8%).

1 · The category is doing the heavy lifting

OAT MILK $ GROWTH	ALMOND (MATURE)	BARISTA TREND	ROOTDAY VS PLAN
+18.8%	**–2.4%**	**0.84**	**-0.2%**
FY25, $1.64B	structural decline	oat-milk volume engine	Q2 FY26, on plan

RootDay's entire strategic advantage is *where it plays*. Within plant-based milk, oat is the growth engine — up +18.8% in FY25 to $1.64B — while almond, the legacy volume leader, is shrinking (–2.4%) and coconut-and-other is flat-to-modest (+4.2%). This is the mirror image of Crunchwell's problem: RootDay does not have to fight its category to grow, it has to keep pace with it. The pull is concentrated in the barista/foodservice occasion — the macro trend Acme tracks at 0.84 strength and labels 'the volume engine of oat milk' — which is exactly the whitespace the FY27 concept slate targets.



Oat is the only segment growing double-digit; almond is in structural decline. Oat FY25 vs prior year; almond/coconut FY24 latest full-year comparators (seed_category_market_size).

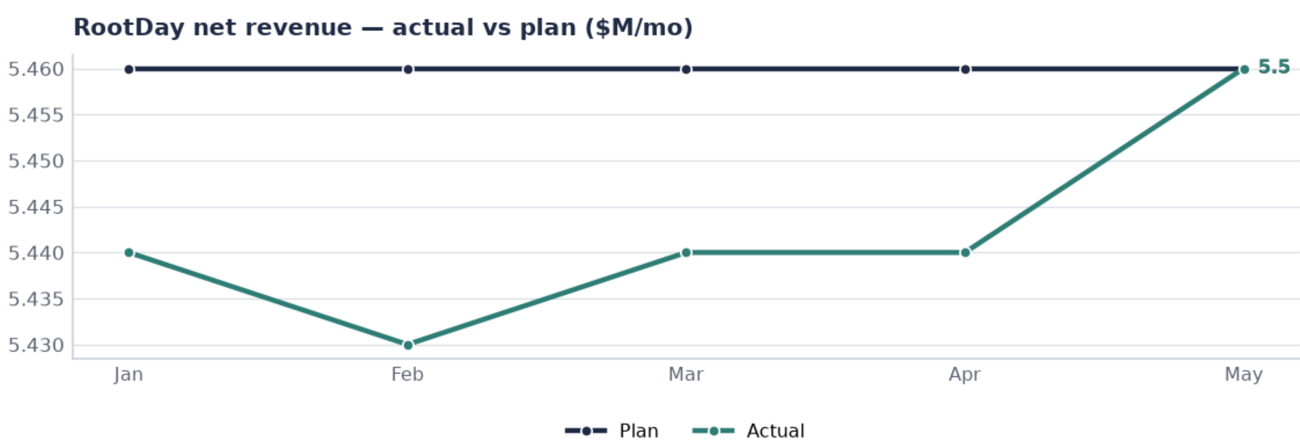
Source: seed_category_market_size (NielsenIQ Total US xAOC), Plant-Based Milk; seed_macro_trends MT002 (oat-milk barista 0.84).

2 · Performance — steady, and on plan

2.1 · RootDay net revenue vs plan — FY26 YTD

Month	Plan	Actual	Var %	Status
Jan	$5.46M	$5.44M	-0.3%	On plan
Feb	$5.46M	$5.43M	-0.6%	On plan
Mar	$5.46M	$5.44M	-0.4%	On plan
Apr	$5.46M	$5.44M	-0.3%	On plan
May	$5.46M	$5.46M	-0.1%	On plan
FY26 YTD (Jan–May)	$27.30M	$27.21M	-0.3%	On plan

Source: plan_vs_actual (Acme ERP shape), RootDay, 2026-01 through 2026-05.



Actuals track plan within a few tenths of a point every month — the steadiest line in the portfolio.

On plan is the right answer here

RootDay is not the brand where Acme needs a heroic number. At –0.3% to plan in Q1 and -0.2% in Q2-to-date, it is doing its job: holding a profitable, growing niche while the portfolio's discretionary innovation dollars flow to ProteinPeak (growth engine) and Crunchwell (flagship turnaround). The FY27 plan protects that discipline.

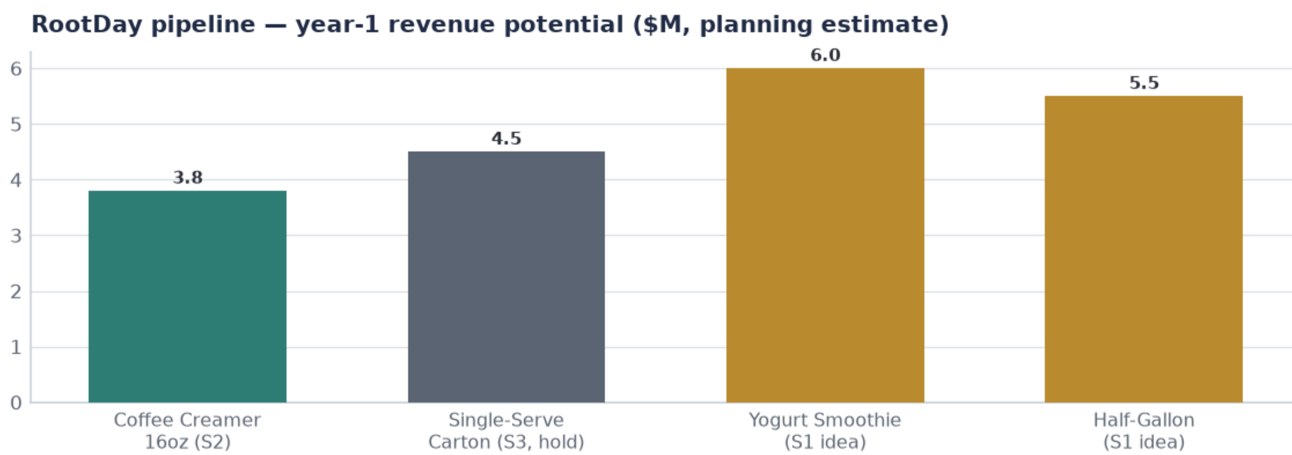
3 · FY27 outlook — grow with the category, land the barista occasion

FY27 is a growth-with-the-category plan, not a step-change. The single most important move is to convert the barista/creamer occasion — the 0.84-strength trend where oat-milk volume actually sits — into a RootDay SKU. Two concepts are in the pipeline and one legacy SKU is being retired. All FY27 revenue figures below are planning estimates carried at the pipeline's stated year-1 potential and confidence, not booked demand.

3.1 · RootDay FY27 concept pipeline

Concept	Stage	Planned	Yr-1 (est.)	Conf.	Status
Coffee Creamer 16oz	S2 Concept	2027-Q3	$3.8M	0.42	On-Track
Single-Serve Carton 8oz	S3 Prototype	2027-Q2	$4.5M	0.58	On-Hold
Coconut Blend - Discontinue	SFinal Discontinue	2026-Q3	$nanM	—	Discontinue-Plan
Yogurt Smoothie	S1 Idea	2028-Q3	$6.0M	0.22	Pre-Stage-Gate
Half-Gallon - Non-Refrigerated	S1 Idea	2028-Q2	$5.5M	0.38	Pre-Stage-Gate

Source: seeds/innovation_pipeline.csv (RootDay). Yr-1 revenue = planning estimate; confidence 0–1.



Coffee Creamer (teal) is the FY27 priority — nearest-stage, on-trend. Single-Serve Carton (grey) is larger but On-Hold. Ideas (gold) are FY28+.

3.2 · Advance: RootDay Coffee Creamer 16oz

Stage-2 concept · $3.8M year-1 planning estimate · confidence 0.42 · target 2027-Q3 · owner Lillian Park. This is the FY27 priority. The barista occasion is where oat-milk volume concentrates (trend 0.84), and a shelf-stable 16oz creamer extends RootDay from the pour-over-cereal and latte occasion into everyday coffee — a foodservice-adjacent, higher-frequency use. The confidence score (0.42) reflects that this is early-stage; the recommendation is to fund concept validation and a barista/foodservice channel test in FY27, not to over-commit spend ahead of the read.

3.3 · Hold: RootDay Single-Serve Carton 8oz

Single-Serve Carton is On-Hold — keep it there for now
INV005 (Stage-3 prototype, $4.5M year-1 planning estimate, confidence 0.58, target 2027-Q2) is the larger single-serve bet, but its status is On-Hold. Single-serve is a real format trend, but with Coffee Creamer the priority barista play and RootDay's innovation budget deliberately modest, the discipline is to hold the carton until Creamer reads and capex/co-man capacity is confirmed. Do not re-activate this quarter.

3.4 · Prune: discontinue Coconut Blend (Q3 FY26)

RootDay Coconut Blend is slated for discontinuation in Q3 FY26 (INV023, Discontinue-Plan). The rationale is portfolio hygiene: coconut-and-other grows only +4.2% against oat's +18.8%, the SKU is a low-velocity niche, and retiring it frees shelf argument and working capital for the on-trend oat and creamer line. Manage the transition with retailers to protect total RootDay distribution.

4 · Risks & the FY27 ask

Watch-items into FY27
(1) Oat-milk is a magnet for entrants — Califia (barista), Silk and Oatly all launched oat SKUs in 2025; RootDay must earn the barista occasion before larger players lock it. (2) The GLP-1/appetite-shift trend (0.81, volume-down) is a low-grade headwind on beverage volume broadly. (3) Coffee Creamer is confidence 0.42 — treat FY27 as a validate-and-test year, not a full-scale launch commitment.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Advance RootDay Coffee Creamer 16oz through concept validation + a barista/foodservice channel test; gate a FY27-Q3 launch decision on the read.	Brand Manager / Lillian Park	FY27 H1
2	Keep Single-Serve Carton 8oz On-Hold; re-evaluate only after Creamer reads and co-man capacity is confirmed.	Lillian Park	FY27 H2 review
3	Execute the Coconut Blend discontinuation with retailer transition management to protect total distribution.	Brand Manager	Q3 FY26
4	Hold the FY27 plan to grow with the oat category (~+15–18% segment); do not over-invest ahead of demand.	Brand Manager / Finance	FY27 plan